

Kill Your Darlings: Final Curated Image Set

Submission map: this document is the curation record. It explicitly identifies the seven final keepers, documents the rejected/cut candidates, and explains the real-over-AI decisions. The separately uploaded image files correspond to the seven assets labelled KEEP below.

7 FINAL KEEPERS

01	KEEPER_01_Home_Hero.jpg	AI connective visual · homepage
02	KEEPER_02_SafeLine_Attack_Log.png	Real capture · security overview
03	KEEPER_03_SQLi_Block.png	Real capture · SQL Injection evidence
04	KEEPER_04_XSS_Block.png	Real capture · XSS detection/denial
05	KEEPER_05_XSS_Payload.png	Real capture · actual test input
06	KEEPER_06_SafeLine_Statistics.png	Real capture · operational context
07	KEEPER_07_Real_Photo.jpg	Real photo · About/personal section

2 REJECTED / CUT

R1	Candidate B — REJECTED	Too visually dominant/decorative; competes with real evidence and weakens readability.
R2	Cleared XSS field screenshot — CUT	Redundant secondary confirmation; the WAF XSS block is the stronger evidence.

HOW TO READ THIS SUBMISSION

The seven files labelled **KEEPER_01** through **KEEPER_07** are the final image assets. The rejected/cut candidates are documented in this PDF rather than being submitted as final assets. The following pages provide the detailed visual evidence and rationale behind each decision.

Final curation principle: real work is shown with real captures; the person is represented by a real photograph; AI is restricted to connective atmosphere; weaker or redundant visuals are removed.

01 — CURATION FRAME

The portfolio does not need more images. It needs the right images.

The portfolio content map is organized around Home, Work, and About/Contact. The image strategy therefore prioritizes direct proof of actual security work, a real photograph for the person, and only one AI-generated connective visual where atmosphere is useful but factual evidence is not required.

Final image inventory

#	Asset	Source	Decision / role
01	Hero texture — Candidate A	AI	KEEP · homepage connective visual
02	SafeLine attack log	REAL CAPTURE	KEEP · compact security proof
03	SQLi WAF block detail	REAL CAPTURE	KEEP · SQL Injection detection/denial
04	XSS WAF block detail	REAL CAPTURE	KEEP · XSS detection/denial
05	XSS payload capture	REAL CAPTURE	KEEP · actual test input
06	SafeLine statistics	REAL CAPTURE	KEEP · broader operational context
07	Personal photograph	REAL PHOTO	KEEP · About/personal section
R1	Hero texture — Candidate B	AI	REJECT · visually dominant/decorative
R2	Cleared XSS field screenshot	REAL CAPTURE	CUT · redundant secondary confirmation

Curation rules applied

- **Evidence beats illustration:** actual project claims are represented by actual captures.
- **People stay real:** the About image is a real photograph, not an AI substitute.
- **AI stays connective:** the generated texture adds atmosphere without pretending to document work.
- **Restraint is a filter:** if a visual competes with the evidence, it does not earn a place.

02 — AI CONNECTIVE VISUAL

Generate → compare → reject → keep.

The AI work was intentionally limited to the one area where the portfolio benefits from atmosphere rather than factual proof: the homepage hero texture.

CANDIDATE A — KEEP



Decision: restrained connective texture.

Why: supports hierarchy, leaves room for proof-led content, and matches the identity's deliberate mood.

CANDIDATE B — REJECT



Decision: rejected.

Why: too visually dominant and decorative; it competes with the portfolio's actual evidence instead of supporting it.

Why Candidate A wins

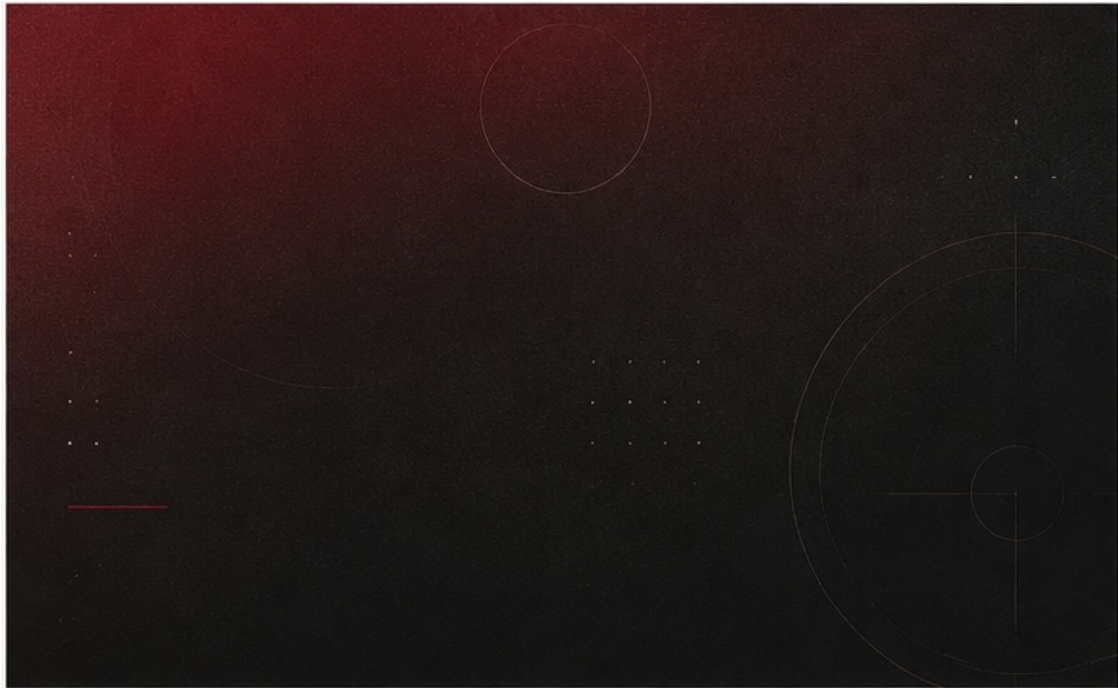
It is technical without becoming literal, uses the Burgundy/Ink language without introducing unrelated colors, and stays quiet enough for real work to remain the visual focus.

The rejected candidate is shown deliberately: the exercise is not merely to display a favorite, but to demonstrate the judgment used to kill a weaker option.

03 — FINAL KEEPER 01

Homepage hero / connective visual

AI-GENERATED · KEEP



Role: full-bleed background texture behind the proof statement / introduction.

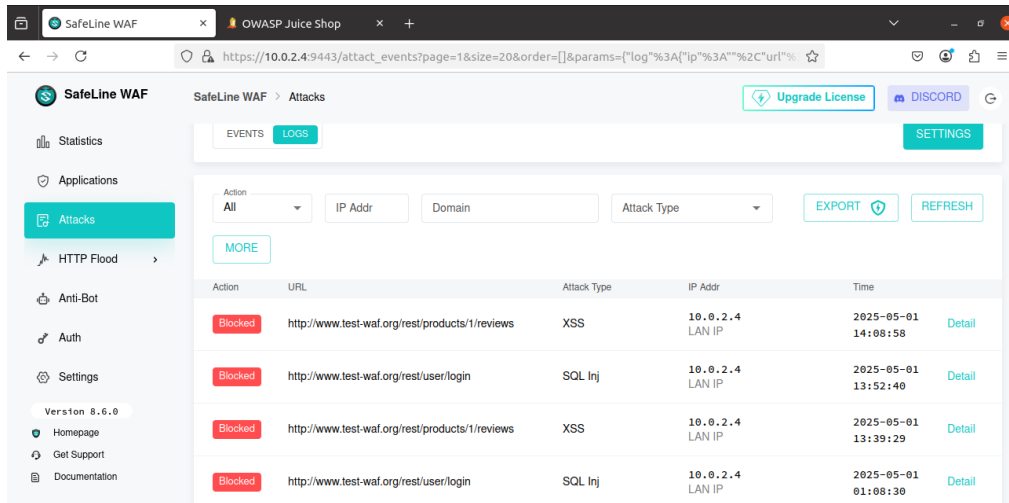
Curation call: atmospheric support only. It does not depict a fake security scene, fake terminal, or invented project evidence.

Identity fit: Deep Burgundy + Ink + Warm White; subtle geometry; low visual noise; generous negative space.

04 — FINAL KEEPERS 02-03

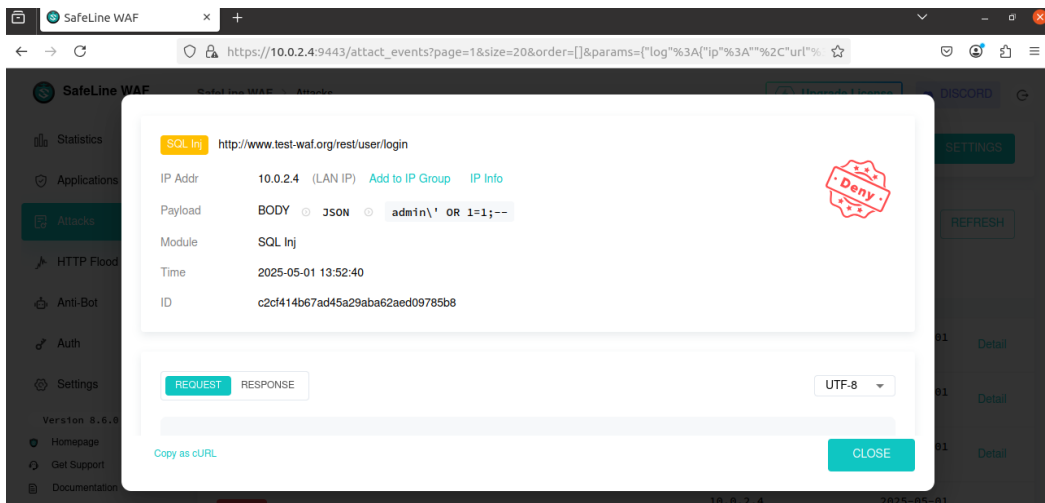
Actual security work: real captures only

02 · SafeLine attack log



KEEP · REAL CAPTURE · Featured-work / security overview. Strong compact proof showing blocked events and attack types in the actual WAF interface.

03 · SQL Injection block detail

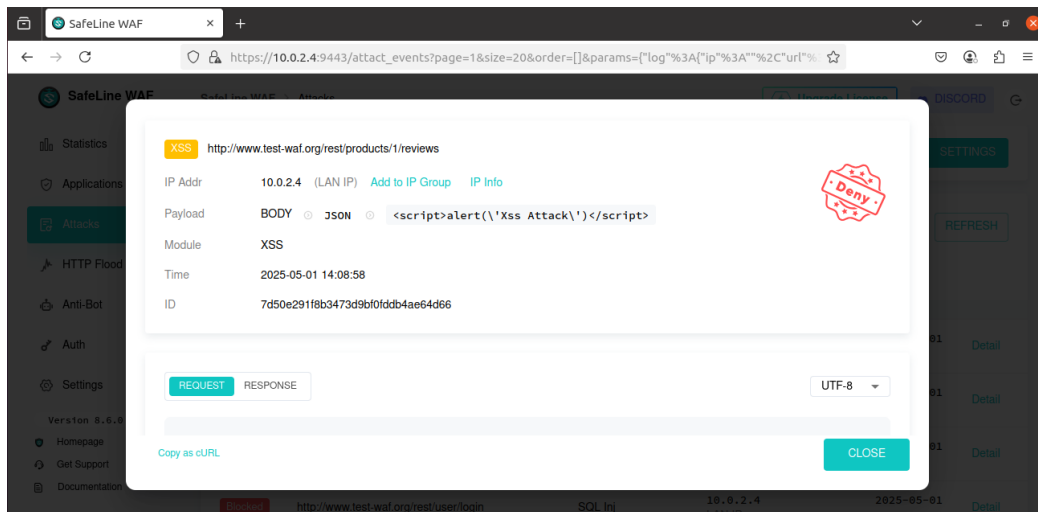


KEEP · REAL CAPTURE · SQL Injection case study. Direct evidence of detection and denial; stronger than any AI recreation of a security interface.

05 — FINAL KEEPERS 04-05

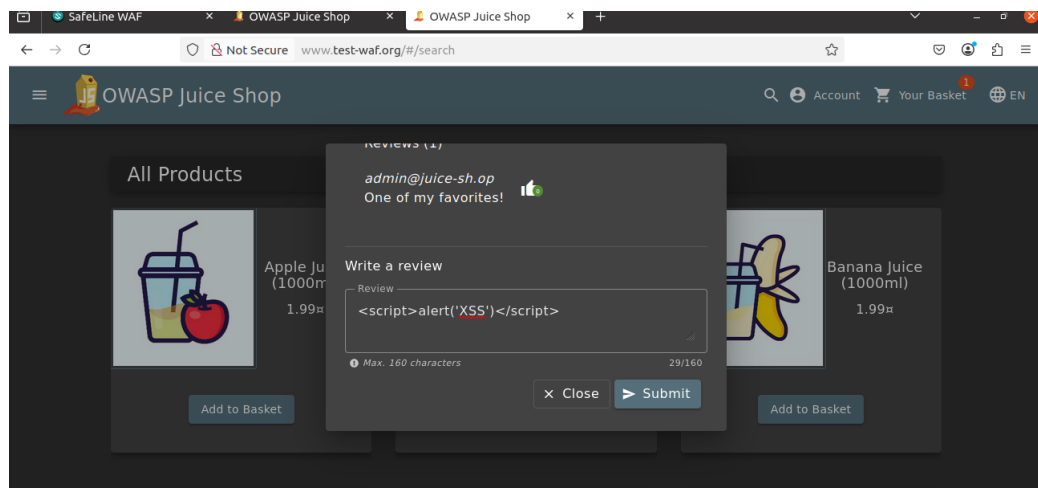
XSS proof: show the work, not a stand-in

04 · XSS WAF block detail



KEEP · REAL CAPTURE · Direct evidence of the WAF detecting and denying the XSS request.

05 · XSS payload capture

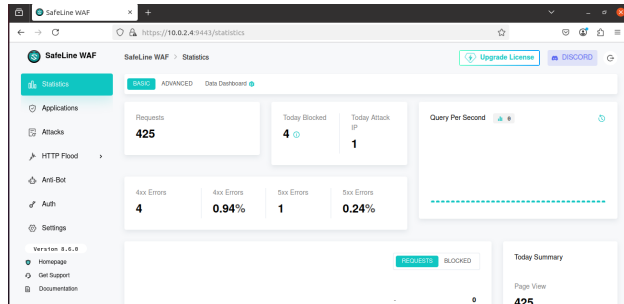


KEEP · REAL CAPTURE · Shows the actual test input used in the Juice Shop review flow.

06 — FINAL KEEPERS 06–07

Context + person

06 · SafeLine statistics



KEEP · REAL CAPTURE

Broader operational/method context. Useful as supporting project evidence without inventing any visual narrative.

07 · About / personal photograph



KEEP · REAL PHOTO

The subject is the portfolio owner, so the image stays photographic and authentic.

Personal-image decision

The grey-background portrait was reviewed but is not promoted to the final set because the brief calls for a real photo when the subject is the person. The final keeper is the actual photograph.

07 — KILL YOUR DARLINGS

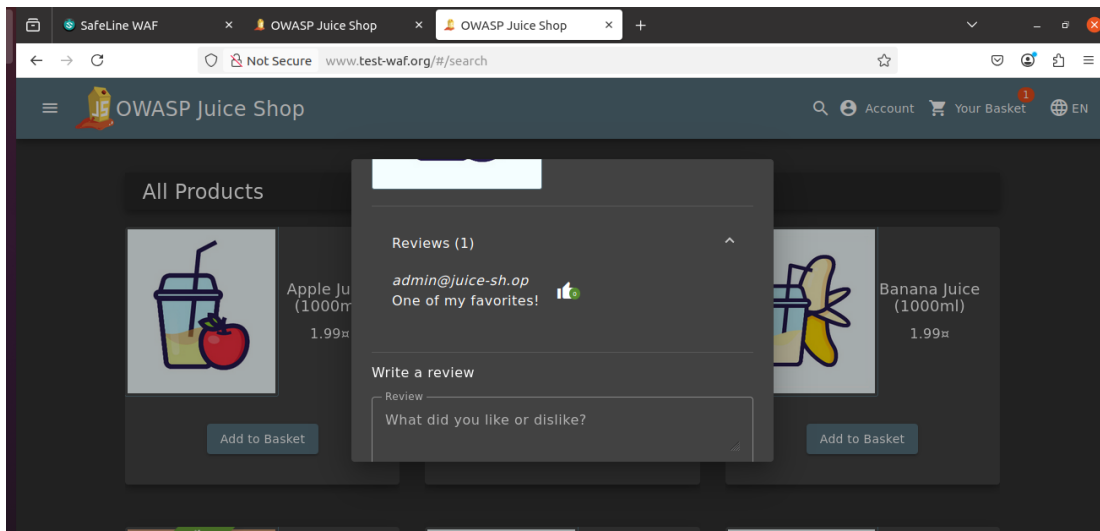
Rejected and removed

R1 · Candidate B — REJECTED



Rejection note: Rejected because the texture is too visually dominant and decorative. It competes with the portfolio's actual evidence and reduces readability; the quieter Candidate A better preserves the deliberate, technical character.

R2 · Cleared XSS field screenshot — CUT



Cut note: Removed because it is redundant secondary confirmation. The SafeLine XSS block event communicates the security outcome more clearly and gives the final set a tighter evidence hierarchy.

08 — REAL OVER AI

The final set follows a simple hierarchy

REAL CAPTURE	Security evidence: attack log, SQLi block, XSS block, XSS payload, statistics.
REAL PHOTO	Personal identity / About section.
AI CONNECTIVE VISUAL	Homepage atmosphere only; no factual claims.
REJECTED / CUT	Decorative AI texture and redundant screenshot removed to keep the set focused.

Final curation principle

The image set prioritizes **evidence over decoration**. Real captures document actual work; a real photograph represents the person; AI is restricted to connective atmosphere; and weaker visuals are removed when they fail to earn their place.

REVIEW CHECK

- ✓ Images map to real portfolio needs
- ✓ Work is represented by real captures, not AI stand-ins
- ✓ Personal subject is represented by a real photograph
- ✓ AI candidate set is coherent and restrained
- ✓ A generated option was explicitly rejected with rationale
- ✓ Redundant evidence was cut rather than padded into the final set

End of curation record · final keeper set documented.